

To the Distinguished Members of the Selection Committee,

It is my great honour to nominate Dr. **Abubaker Abdul Rahman Shaffi Al Madani** (Consultant Neurologist and Head of the Department of Neurology at Rashid Hospital, and **Professor of Neurology at Mohammed Bin Rashid University of Medicine and Health Sciences**) for the National Award for Distinguished Personalities, in recognition of outstanding and impactful contributions to the UAE healthcare sector.

Across more than fifteen years of continuous national service, Dr. Abubaker has built what is today the largest neurology service in the United Arab Emirates, caring for more than 20,000 patients each year. His career maps precisely onto the three evaluation parameters for this award: leadership, mentorship, community engagement and patient advocacy.

As Head of Neurology at Rashid Hospital and Vice President of the Emirates Neurology Society (EMINS), Dr. Abubaker co-developed the departmental stroke programme to German Stroke Society accreditation and led the accreditation of Rashid Hospital as a MENACTRIMS MS Centre. The 18-bed Rashid Hospital Neurology and Stroke Unit (inaugurated in 2019 by H.E. Humaid Al Qutami, Director-General of the DHA) was delivered under his clinical leadership, and he is a core faculty member of the Rashid Hospital neurology residency programme, involved in the training of the next generation of Emirati neurologists.

Dr. Abubaker founded Dubai Health's multidisciplinary headache service, extending specialist care to Al Barsha and Nad Al Hamar primary health centres. This intervention lifted specialist-referral uptake rise from approximately five percent to nearly fifty percent, with patient satisfaction of 80–90 percent; a direct, measurable impact on Dubai's patient community.

He served as Congress President of the 3rd Dubai Neurology Congress (February 2023), which drew international participation, and chaired the EMINS Virtual Congress that convened more than 16,500 delegates worldwide. He helped lead the EMINS GCC Migraine Patient Advisory Board in November 2022 in Dubai, and drive the first Gulf application of the European Migraine and Headache Alliance access-to-care methodology, published in *Pain and Therapy* (2024).

Dr. Abubaker's 40+ peer-reviewed publications and 378 scholarly citations place the UAE firmly within global neuroscience networks. He has contributed, as reviewer or co-author, to the UAE's first national Multiple Sclerosis treatment guidelines (now integrated into the DHA's Multiple Sclerosis Ejadah Programme), the UAE Alzheimer's Disease national framework, and the Saudi Consensus guidelines on the diagnosis and management of Myasthenia Gravis.

These achievements reflect the values this award seeks to honour: an Emirati physician whose service is at once clinical, academic, institutional, and profoundly national, and whose work has connected UAE neurology to the European Headache Federation, the European Migraine and Headache Alliance, and the World Federation of Neurology.

He has measurably raised the standard of neurological care available to every UAE resident and has trained the physicians who will carry that standard forward.

I commend this nomination to the committee's highest consideration.

Respectfully submitted,



Name: Dr. Babacar Cisse

Title / Institution: Consultant Neurosurgeon & Chairman of Neurosciences, Dubai Health

Date: 19 May 2026